

2 A VERIFICATION DOCUMENTATION OF AN UNUSUAL RECORD

1. Species: Groove-Billed Ani crotophaga sulcirostris Number: _____
(Vernacular Name) (Scientific Name)
3. Location: CF+I Res. Pueblo, Colo.
4. Date(s): October 15, 1975 5. Time bird seen: 5:00 6:5:04
6. Description of size, shape and color-pattern. (Describe in great detail all parts of the plumage including beak and feet coloration in addition to the diagnostic characteristics; however, include only what actually was seen in the field.):

about the size of a grackle, very long tail
 Thick bill. Dull Black all over. ~~Tail feathers~~
 spaces between the tail feathers. Flapped its wings
 very fast, but didn't fly very well, flew ruggedly.
 wings didn't extend to the tail.
7. Description of voice, if heard: 2 notes, 1st seemed to be longer than 2nd, at + mes.
8. Description of behavior: was climbing or hopping on dead ~~branches~~ branches of the tree, etc
9. Habitat - general: arid grass land
 specific: Brushy, dry ditch, willows, Rabbit Brush, Tabernisk
10. Similarly appear to species which you have seen before? Grackle: has a thin bill and more graceful flight.
11. Distance (how many feet): 50-60 yds. approx. used (1st - 1st)
12. Optical equipment: 10x50 Binoculars
13. Light (day, night, twilight, position of sun, etc.): day, clear, I was between the sun and the bird.
14. Previous experience with this species, and how early you first observed it: Never seen this species here. Grackles are very very common.
15. What made you think this species was unusual? The 1st thing I saw that made me think it was unusual
16. Other observers: was the first
17. Did others agree with your identification? NONE
18. Other observers who independently identified this bird:
19. Books, illustrations and articles consulted and how did these influence this documentation: "Field guide to Western Birds" confirmed my observations.
20. If bird was photographed, please attach pictures and describe equipment used:

Signature: Eddie Blatnick Street Address: 2024 Birchwood
 Date Prepared: October 20, 1975 City and State: Pueblo, Colo

(10) voice is completely different. Usually has some iridescence on head. It is glossy black, not dull black. Also has yellow ~~eye~~. Tail looks shorter probably because the wings extend to the tail.

m

6

m